WORKBOOK 01 / 04

Start with the strategic choice

Use evidence to change a buying decision. Complete a working draft, then test it with people.

THE POINT OF VIEW

When competitors tell the same story, they reinforce the same buying criteria. Narrative design should challenge those criteria—with a market insight customers recognize and an approach your business can credibly lead.

01 / ESTABLISH THE BRIEF

AUDIENCE + SITUATION

Who is deciding, in which real situation?

OBJECTIVE + ACTION

What should they understand or do differently?

ACTUAL ALTERNATIVES

What would they use or do without your product?

DELIVERED ADVANTAGE

Which relevant difference can you substantiate?

02 / TURN EVIDENCE INTO AN INSIGHT

OBSERVATION

What recurring tension do customers recognize? Record source, date and scope.

INTERPRETATION

Which accepted assumption does it challenge? Keep inference separate from fact.

BELIEF SHIFT

From which current belief to which useful belief? Which buying criterion changes?

CHOOSE THE ARC BEFORE WRITING

Change-led: a meaningful external shift is established. Use page 2. **Reframe-led:** a persistent situation is misunderstood, with no established shift. Use the alternative on page 2. If neither is supported, clarify the value proposition or investigate further.

WORKBOOK 02 / 04

Build the change-led argument

Marcus Andrews' five-stage method. Write the causal connection, not just a headline.

1 The Change

What changed, compared with when, and for whom? What evidence supports the shift, its significance and its limits?

2 The Impact

Which audience decision or outcome changes, and how? Make the stakes specific before introducing the product.

3 The New Game

What should people do differently? Define practical actions, success criteria and trade-offs. Is the method useful without your product?

4 Why It's Hard

Which real barriers block this approach? Include organizational, technical, economic or behavioral constraints the product cannot solve.

5 The Solution

Which delivered capability addresses each barrier? Explain how it changes the work, for whom, and with what evidence.

REFRAME-LED ALTERNATIVE / PRACTICAL COMPANION EXTENSION

Use this arc when the evidence supports a persistent problem or contradiction, rather than a meaningful external change:

Recognizable situation → consequential contradiction → new interpretation → practical approach → barriers → credible product contribution → next action.

This alternative is not Andrews' five-stage method. Do not invent a trend to complete the template.

WORKBOOK 03 / 04

Connect the product to the proof

Complete one chain for the most important barrier. Repeat it for other material claims.

CUSTOMER OBSTACLE	A barrier to the proposed approach, grounded in the audience’s work.
DELIVERED CAPABILITY	What works today? Note configuration, access and dependencies.
PRACTICAL MECHANISM	How does it change the work? Include the human or process contribution.
CUSTOMER OUTCOME	For whom, under which conditions? Include adoption effort and trade-offs.
EVIDENCE + LIMITS	Source, date, population or use case, result and what it does not establish.

KEEP FOUR KINDS OF SUPPORT SEPARATE

Evidence for the market change, the recommended approach, product behavior and business impact answer different questions. A demo does not prove reliable deployment; positive reactions do not prove purchase or revenue.

PRESSURE-TEST THE ARGUMENT

1. **Logic:** Where is the earliest unsupported link? For a reframe-led arc, test the contradiction and its interpretation.

2. **Alternatives:** Could a competitor use this unchanged? Why would a capable buyer rationally keep the current approach?

3. **Comprehension:** Can an unfamiliar prospect retell the approach, product contribution and next action without coaching?

WEAKEST LINK + REPAIR / EVIDENCE NEEDED

Decide: advance to a defined test, refine a specific gap, or rebuild the premise. Coherence is not proof of effectiveness.

WORKBOOK 04 / 04

Make it clear. Make it credible.

Use these practical companion checks before adapting the story into a real asset or conversation.

AI LANGUAGE / USE WHEN AI IS MATERIAL

Temporarily remove AI labels. Are the customer, value, mechanism and reason to choose still clear? Restore terms that add necessary precision.

For each material claim, explain:
- the task, inputs and delivered behavior;
- human judgment, permissions and exceptions;
- what is possible, live, measured or forecast;
- proof suited to the promise.

For agents, verify the resulting task or system state. A convincing response does not establish that the work was completed.

READ-ALOUD REVIEW / USE EVERY TIME

Read the draft aloud. Mark places where you lose breath, stumble, reread or cannot explain the connection between ideas.

Check for:
- one understandable idea at a time;
- concrete work, credible stakes and empathy;
- natural rhythm and useful transitions;
- a specific idea worth remembering.

Ask a listener to retell the argument and the next action. Treat their response as evidence within that context, not a revenue forecast.

REVISION TO MAKE NOW

USEFUL STARTER PROMPTS

Build from facts	Help me build a narrative for [audience / decision] using [product facts and research]. Separate supported claims from hypotheses and choose the appropriate arc.
Find the weak link	Pressure-test this draft. Identify the earliest unsupported assumption, the strongest credible objection and the smallest repair that addresses both.
Check an AI promise	Review this AI claim against the available evidence. Explain the delivered behavior, human role and product limits; flag any leap from demonstration to outcome.
Review spoken flow	Review this script for first-hearing clarity, breath, rhythm and credibility. Preserve concrete detail and qualifications that affect the truth.

Method credit: Marcus Andrews, Narrative Design for Business.
m3ka.com/frameworks/narrative-design

Independent practical companion by Shauna Azevedo-Brennan. The reframe-led alternative, proof mapping, pressure tests and editorial checks are companion extensions, not official Andrews methodology.